Response Paper:

The works of Guillermo Palchik and Daniel Rosenberg problematize the widespread technological acceptance of data as an objective and indisputable "truth." Rosenberg delves into the etymological roots of the concept, revealing that "data" derives from the Latin verb *dare* (to give) and that historically it was not a "fact" or "evidence," but rather the "given thing" accepted as a starting point in a discussion. Palchik, in turn, applies this historical and philosophical foundation to modern data science; according to him, while current systems can technically process data (syntax), they cannot determine whether this processing is logically valid (legitimate). The fundamental point where the two authors converge is that data is not a truth that speaks for itself, but rather a rhetorical construction that gains meaning within the context and constraints established by humans.

The conceptual tension between the texts lies in the problem of "decontextualizing" data. Rosenberg shows that data was used as an "unquestionable antecedent" in mathematics and theology until the 18th century, but that it eventually became an empirical finding. However, Palchik warns that modern algorithms still treat data as those old, "meaningless symbols" that Rosenberg described. For computers, there is no difference between a "Customer ID" and a "Sales Quantity"; both are summable numbers, but summing the IDs is meaningless. This situation, combined with what Rosenberg called a "rhetorical tool" and what Palchik calls "illegal questions" leads to the production of seemingly technically perfect but falsely accurate results (plausible nonsense).

My key takeaway from these texts is that data literacy is not merely a technical skill, but a "guardianship of meaning" that delineates the ontological boundaries of data. Agnostic data thinking requires questioning the production process and semantic type of data, rather than blindly accepting it. In this context, the dialogue between the texts gives rise to the following critical questions:

1. If, as Rosenberg points out, data is not an ontological reality but a rhetorical "acceptance," should we classify the predictive models that artificial intelligence systems build upon these acceptances not as "objective science," but merely as "high-scale rhetoric"?
2. When Palchik's concept of "measurement drift" is combined with Rosenberg's idea of the historical transformation of data, can the "expiration of meaning" of a dataset be technically calculated, or should this remain a purely qualitative judgment?

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